

Retatrutide

Retatrutide (GLP-1/GIP/GCG Triple Agonist)

FAT LOSS

WEIGHT LOSS

INSULIN
SENSITIVITY

CARDIOVASCULAR

NEXT GEN

WHAT IS IT?

Retatrutide (LY3437943) is Eli Lilly's next-generation triple receptor agonist targeting GLP-1 (glucagon-like peptide-1), GIP (glucose-dependent insulinotropic polypeptide), and GCG (glucagon) receptors simultaneously. Phase 3 trials show 24.2% body weight reduction at 48 weeks at the highest dose — surpassing all other weight loss medications ever studied. Expected FDA approval 2025–2026.

DOSING AT A GLANCE

Starting Dose (wkly)	Max Studied Dose	Frequency	Protocol
2–4 mg	Up to 12 mg	Once weekly	Titrate up

KEY BENEFITS

- 24.2% body weight reduction in Phase 3 (highest dose, 48 weeks) — unprecedented
- Dual GLP-1 + GIP action (like Tirzepatide) plus GCG receptor for metabolic boost
- Significant visceral and liver fat reduction
- Cardiovascular risk reduction — improves lipid profile, blood pressure, HbA1c
- Appetite suppression + improved satiety signaling
- Improved insulin sensitivity and glycemic control
- Liver fat reduction — potential NASH/MAFLD treatment
- Once-weekly injection for high compliance

HOW IT WORKS

Retatrutide agonizes three distinct receptors: GLP-1R (appetite suppression, slow gastric emptying, insulin secretion), GIPR (enhanced insulin response, fat metabolism), and GCGR (increased energy expenditure, lipolysis, hepatic glucose regulation). The glucagon component drives thermogenesis and liver fat mobilization not seen with dual agonists.

PROTOCOLS

- **Starting:** 2 mg SC weekly x 4 weeks, then titrate up every 4 weeks.

- **Target dose:** 8–12 mg/week (per Phase 3 protocol) for maximum fat loss.
- **Maintenance:** Lowest effective dose that maintains weight loss.
- **Compounded:** Available from compounding pharmacies; verify purity before use.

SIDE EFFECTS

- Nausea, vomiting, diarrhea, constipation (GI class effects — typically transient)
- Hypoglycemia (especially combined with insulin secretagogues)
- Decreased appetite and caloric intake
- Muscle mass loss (mitigate with high protein + resistance training)
- Injection site reactions (mild)
- Tachycardia at higher doses (GCG effect)

STORAGE

Refrigerate (2–8°C). Do not freeze. Reconstituted: refrigerate, use within 28 days.

■ ***Contraindicated in personal/family history of medullary thyroid carcinoma or MEN2. Not approved — use compounded with verified supplier.***

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